

Education, Early Childhood

Master of Education

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PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

The Early Childhood Education Program offers coursework and field experiences leading to the Master of Education with Teacher Certifications (Class A and Alternative Class A 5th Year) in Early Childhood Education (P-3).

Certification

All teacher education majors that have met the requirements must apply for Alabama Certification. A candidate who files an application must complete the curriculum approved by the State of Alabama. The completion of the curriculum approved for certification and all other requirements for graduation will qualify the student to apply for a professional educator's certificate. The levels of Alabama Professional Educator Certificates for students in the graduate program are Class A: Master's degree and Class AA: Ed.S. degree.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#). Specific requirements to this program are as follows:

Early Childhood Education (P-3), Class A

In addition to specific course requirements, applicants seeking admission must:

1. Be admitted to Teacher Education. Admission to Teacher Education requires the applicant to:
 - a. Present evidence of having completed a baccalaureate degree in a teaching field in which the degree is sought from a regionally accredited institution.
 - b. Present a copy of a Class B Professional Educator's Certificate (regular master's program).
 - c. Present transcript(s) showing a baccalaureate degree grade point average of 2.50 or better (4.00 system).

Early Childhood Education (P-3), Alternative Class A 5th Year

The alternative 5th year program is for applicants who do not hold a baccalaureate degree in a teaching field but wishes to obtain teacher certification. The program enables qualified candidates to acquire the knowledge and skills of an entry-level teacher while at the same time earn a Master's degree.

In addition to specific course requirements, applicants seeking admission must:

1. Be admitted to Teacher Education. Admission to Teacher Education requires the applicant to:
 - a. Present evidence of having completed a baccalaureate degree from a regionally accredited institution.
 - b. Present transcript(s) showing a baccalaureate degree grade point average of 2.50 or better (4.00 system).
 - c. Complete all undergraduate deficiencies.
 - d. Undergo the required fingerprint/background check.

Internship Prerequisite

Graduate students who expect to participate in internship shall meet all the Teacher Education program admission criteria described in the Alabama Administrative Code. Only students who have a minimum of 3.25 grade point average (GPA) overall will be eligible for internship. Graduate students must obtain and maintain a minimum overall of 3.25 grade point average (GPA) throughout their program. An application for internship must be completed and filed in the Office of Field Experiences at least one semester prior to the internship semester. The deadline dates are communicated on the website. Before a graduate student can participate in internship, the following Prerequisite must be met:

1. The student must have on file an application to an Educator Preparation Program.
2. The student must meet all requirements for admission to an Educator Preparation Program.
3. The student must meet general studies requirements.
4. The student must have obtained and maintained a minimum of 3.00 grade point average in professional studies, the teaching field and 3.25 GPA overall.
5. All undergraduate deficiencies must be completed.
6. The student must have completed all coursework (excluding internship) from the approved ALSDE program checklist.
7. The student must have removed all grades of "Incomplete."
8. The student must not have any grades lower than "C" in any course.
9. Program of study must be on file with the Educator Preparation Program and the Graduate Office.
10. Official transcripts from other universities and colleges attended must be on file with the Educator Preparation Program.
11. The student must obtain requisite score on the Praxis II Tests in appropriate area of concentration.
12. The student must clear the fingerprint/background check with the State Department of Education.

All students enrolled in the Alternative Master's (5th year program) must complete 219 hours of diverse field experience prior to enrolling in the fall or spring semester of internship.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Early Childhood Education (P-3), Class A

Candidates must successfully:

1. Complete all coursework on the State-approved Checklist.
2. Obtain an overall GPA of ≥ 2.50 based on a 4.00 system.
3. Pass a written comprehensive examination that covers the content of the program.
4. Make application for certification through the Teacher Education and Certification Office.

Early Childhood Education (P-3), Alternative Class A 5th Year

Candidates must successfully:

1. Complete all coursework on the State-approved Checklist.